Foam rolling — upper body (hEDS / HSD safe)

Soft-tissue rolling for tightness (R7) · after training or on rest days, never before a session · pick by target

Target area

Chest · Shoulder / cuff · Back / lats · Upper arms · Forearms / neck

⚠ What rolling does — and what it can't

Rolling eases the feeling of tightness, mostly through your nervous system: pain and tension settle for a while. It doesn't 'release' fascia, and harder pressure adds nothing. Light pressure, muscle only — EDS tissue needs care. Tightness is what rolling is for; range is not (R7).

AREAS — pick by what you trained (30–60 s an area · ~5–8 min a sitting)

Muscle only · light pressure, about 3–4/10 · slow passes, 2–4 s each way · ball against the wall where you can

Back, chest and shoulders

1	Upper back beside the spine (ball against the wall)	30–60 s per side	
	Erector spinae · rhomboids · mid-trap	tennis ball	
	Ball between the spine and the shoulder blade; lean in gently, small circles	wall	
	Never on the spine, no lying across the roller: that bends the joints, not the muscle (R7)		
2	Chest (ball against the wall)	30–60 s per side	
	Pec major — below the collarbone, toward the breastbone	tennis ball	
	Lean in gently; small, slow arm moves below shoulder height	wall	
	Never sweep the arm behind you or overhead (R1); stop if the shoulder shifts or tingles		
3	Lats (side-lying on the roller)	30–60 s per side	
	Latissimus dorsi — the muscle behind the ribs, below the armpit	foam roller	
	Bottom arm bent at ~90–120°, resting — not straight overhead (R1)		
	Roll from below the armpit to mid-ribs, on the muscle; no direct rib pressure		
4	Back of the shoulder (ball against the wall)	20–40 s per side	
	Infraspinatus · teres minor · rear delt	tennis ball	
	Ball on the flat muscle below the ridge of the shoulder blade; small circles	wall	
	Very light; a shoulder that feels looser afterwards → leave it out next time (§2.6)		

Arms

5	Triceps (ball against the wall or on the bench)	30–60 s per arm	
	Triceps — the middle of the back of the upper arm	tennis ball	
	Roll from mid-arm toward the shoulder; light pressure		
	Stay off the elbow and the tendon just above it		
6	Biceps (ball on the bench or a table)	20–40 s per arm	
	Biceps · brachialis — the middle of the front of the upper arm	tennis ball	
	Arm resting on the ball; very light pressure		
	Mid-muscle only: the biceps tendons run above and below it		
7	Forearms, palm up then palm down (ball on the bench)	20–30 s each side	
	Wrist and finger flexors · extensors	tennis ball	
	Roll from below the elbow to a hand's width above the wrist		
	Gentle; stay well away from the wrist and the elbow		

Last — the neck–shoulder ridge

8	Upper traps + levator (ball against the wall)	30–40 s per side	
	Upper trapezius · levator scapulae — the neck–shoulder ridge	tennis ball	
	Lean in and hold with slow breathing; no rolling	wall	
	Never on the neck itself; tingling down the arm → move off the spot		

Every area, every time — hEDS / HSD rules

- Muscle only — never on a joint, tendon, bony point, the spine, the neck or straight on the ribs
- Light pressure: about 3–4/10, never sharp — harder adds nothing; lacrosse ball: same limit, lean in less
- Slow passes, 2–4 s each way; pause up to 20–30 s on a tender spot; 30–60 s an area
- Positions stay short of end range: no arm straight overhead, no sweep behind you (R1)
- Tingling, numbness, or a joint that feels looser → stop and move off; leave that area out next time (§2.6)

Target index — pick areas by what you trained

Chest	2
Back of the shoulder / rear delt	4
Front and side delts	not rolled — a tendon and a bursa lie just under them
Upper back / erectors	1
Lats	3
Triceps	5
Biceps	6
Forearms / grip	7
Neck–shoulder ridge	8, always last
Abs	not rolled — organs lie under them

When and how long

After training (later that day) or on rest days — never before a session (it adds range that fades)

Pick 3–5 areas by what you trained · ~5–8 min a sitting · kit: foam roller + tennis ball (or lacrosse ball)